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RFP WTA-2026-114 — Managed SD-WAN and Network Services

Issued by: Wrenfell Transit Authority

Issue date: 2 July 2026

Closing date and time: 14 August 2026 at 3:00 p.m. local time

Term: Five years from the service commencement date, with two optional renewals of two years each, exercisable by the Authority alone.

Enquiries: Enquiries must be in writing and received not later than seven calendar days before the closing time. Enquiries of general application and the Authority's answers to them are issued by numbered addendum to all registered Bidders. No oral statement by any employee or agent of the Authority binds the Authority or varies this RFP.

Submissions and enquiries are directed to the Manager, Procurement Services, Wrenfell Transit Authority, Head Office, Halwick Yard, Wrenfell.

1. Purpose

Wrenfell Transit Authority invites bids for a managed wide area network service, to be delivered as a software-defined wide area network (SD-WAN), covering every site described in section 2 for the term stated above. The Authority is procuring an outcome rather than an asset. Title to the equipment at the network edge stays with the successful Bidder, which is answerable for its condition, for keeping it current over the term, and for the service the Authority draws from it.

The network the service replaces reaches its contract expiry on 31 March 2027, and the Authority will not extend it. Transition of every site onto the new service must therefore be planned and completed against that date, in the migration windows set out in section 2.

This RFP sets out the scope of work at section 2, mandatory requirements at section 3, rated requirements at section 4, the pricing submission at section 5, and the method by which bids will be evaluated at section 6. Bidders must respond to each requirement in sections 3 and 4 by reference number.

2. Scope of Work

The Authority delivers scheduled bus service, community shuttle routes and door-to-door accessible transportation on behalf of its member municipalities, carrying in the order of 21 million boardings a year with a fleet of about 600 vehicles. The network in scope is the network on which that service depends.

Sites. Forty-six fixed sites are in scope: four operating depots; the operations control centre; the head office; an operations annex opened in 2025 that houses the revenue and fare group and a secondary control position; six transit terminals and passenger facilities; and thirty-three on-street cabinets, at signalised intersections where the Authority holds transit priority and at stops carrying a real-time sign. Each depot also hosts the aggregation point through which the on-vehicle systems of its assigned vehicles reach the Authority's applications. The Authority may add or close

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sites during the term.

What the network carries. The dispatch and vehicle-location systems run from first pull-out to last pull-in, currently 04:50 to 01:10; an interruption at a depot during pull-out puts vehicles into service late. Fare validation cannot lose a transaction, and revenue is reconciled overnight. The hosted unified communications service placed in service in 2024 now depends on this network end to end, including the customer enquiry line and the specialised transportation booking line through which a substantial share of accessible trips is booked, and on which the Authority's obligation to offer equivalent service on every published channel partly rests. Camera and vehicle-health recordings are retrieved from vehicles at each depot overnight, in volumes larger than everything else the network carries combined. Passenger-information updates at terminals and on-street signs are the most publicly visible thing the network does and the least urgent.

Current state. The existing network was procured in 2013 as a single-carrier MPLS arrangement sized for terminal and file traffic. All internet access is concentrated at the head office, which is now the busiest and least resilient point in the estate. Access equipment at three of the four depots is past vendor support and cannot be extended.

Required service. The Authority requires one managed SD-WAN overlay carrying all forty-six sites and all four depot aggregation points, administered as a single service.

Two independent transports are required at every fixed site, and the Authority requires both of them to be in use. A second path that sits dark until the first one fails, or that has to be brought up by hand, will not be accepted as the second transport. At depots, the control centre, the head office, the operations annex and the transit terminals the two transports must be diverse wireline services; at on-street cabinets, where a second wireline service is unavailable or uneconomic, the Authority will accept wireless transport, provided the Bidder states what it does not guarantee at such a site. Loss of one transport at a depot or at the operations control centre must not interrupt dispatch.

The treatment given to each kind of traffic must be set centrally and applied identically at every site, and a change to that treatment must be made once rather than site by site. Which of the Authority's systems yield, and in what order, when a site is left with one working path is a decision the Authority makes and records. The Bidder gives that decision effect in configuration, keeps it in force, and shows in its reporting that it held. The Authority must approve any change to it in writing before the change is staged.

The service must be monitored and supported continuously, on every day of the year. The Authority operates no overnight network staff and will not be the first party to detect a fault.

Migration windows. Transition must be complete before the expiry date in section 1. No cutover at a fixed site may be attempted between 15 August and 30 September, when the autumn service change and the return of schools and the regional college place the system at its annual peak; during the two-week summer festival service period; or between 15 December and 6 January, when extended holiday service operates. Cutovers otherwise occur in nightly windows outside revenue service, booked with the affected site and with the operations control centre.

Excluded. The local area networks inside Authority buildings, the on-vehicle systems themselves, and the hosted unified communications platform are held under separate agreements and are not in scope, though the successful Bidder is responsible for the demarcation with each.

3. Mandatory Requirements

Each requirement below is assessed on a pass or fail basis before any bid is scored under section 4. A bid that fails any one of them will be given no further consideration, and the Authority will not waive a mandatory requirement. Bidders must complete the Compliance column and cite the part of the bid in which each requirement is answered.

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Ref	Requirement	Compliance
M1	Describe the proposed managed SD-WAN service, including overlay architecture, transport diversity and central policy management.	
M2	Describe the 24x7 network operations centre and service desk model, including escalation tiers and response targets by severity.	
M3	Confirm the Bidder is incorporated in Canada and has provided comparable managed network services for at least five years.	
M4	Provide references from three comparable transit or public-sector clients.	

4. Rated Requirements

Bids that pass every mandatory requirement are scored against the requirements below, out of a total of 55 points allocated as shown. Each requirement is scored on the material in the bid itself; the evaluation committee will not infer an answer from elsewhere in the bid or from the Bidder's prior dealings with the Authority. An assertion offered without the evidence a requirement asks for will be scored at zero.

Ref	Requirement	Points
R1	Provide a network transition and cutover plan, including migration sequencing, parallel operation, rollback criteria and freeze periods.	14
R2	Demonstrate understanding of the Authority's operating environment, service obligations and accountability requirements.	8
R3	Describe the proposed service levels and the performance reporting regime, including review cadence.	13
R4	Provide evidence of ISO/IEC 27001 certification covering the delivery centre from which the service will be operated.	10
R5	Data residency: confirm that all Authority traffic and all management telemetry will remain within the province, and describe the controls that enforce this data residency requirement.	10

5. Pricing

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Pricing is submitted in a separate sealed envelope, marked with the procurement number and the Bidder's legal name, and is opened only after the requirements in sections 3 and 4 have been scored. The pricing envelope is worth 45 points.

The envelope must contain the pricing schedule issued with this RFP, completed in full: a monthly recurring charge for each site type in the design, a monthly charge for each depot aggregation point, one-time transition and installation charges, and the rate at which a site added during the term is charged. Amounts are stated in Canadian dollars, exclusive of applicable taxes and inclusive of all equipment, licensing, transport, monitoring, maintenance, refresh and travel. Charges must be firm for the initial five-year term. A pricing envelope that is incomplete, qualified or conditional may be found non-compliant.

Out of scope for this exercise. The pricing schedule is not reproduced or populated in this synthetic corpus, and no rate, unit price or contract value appears in it.

6. Evaluation Method

Evaluation proceeds in three stages, and a bid must clear each stage to reach the next.

At the first stage the evaluation committee assesses each bid against the mandatory requirements at section 3 on a pass or fail basis. Failure of any one requirement ends the evaluation of that bid.

At the second stage the committee scores each remaining bid against the rated requirements at section 4, out of 55 points. Each requirement is scored independently by every member of the committee against a defined scale, and the committee then agrees a single consensus score for each requirement with its reasons recorded.

At the third stage the pricing envelope of each remaining bid is opened and scored out of 45 points, the lowest compliant total evaluated price receiving the full allocation and every other bid a proportion of it.

The technical and pricing scores are added to give a total out of 100. The Authority intends to recommend award to the Bidder with the highest total, but reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, to cancel this RFP at any time, and to require a shortlisted Bidder to present its transition plan to the committee before award. The Authority is not liable for any cost of preparing a bid.